

SUPERSTORE SALES ANALYSIS

Key Insights and Business Recommendations

Prepared from the Excel PivotTables and Power BI dashboard for the Mainkraft Technology internship task

1. Executive Summary

This report reviews the Sample Superstore dataset using Excel PivotTables and a Power BI dashboard. The analysis covers overall sales and profit, regional performance, category contribution, monthly sales patterns, and individual products shown in the product-sales chart. With the full dataset selected in Power BI, the dashboard shows total sales of approximately **2,296,919.49** and total profit of approximately **286,409.08**. Excel PivotTables help explain where sales are coming from and when demand is strongest. The main findings are that West and East contribute the largest sales amounts, Technology is the highest-selling category, and sales rise sharply in September and especially November and December. These patterns can guide inventory planning, regional sales activity, and further profitability analysis.

Headline figures (full dataset, with Power BI filters cleared): Total Sales: 2,296,919.49 | Total Profit: 286,409.08

2. Key Findings from Excel and Power BI

Regional performance. West records the highest sales at approximately **725,457.82**, followed by East at **678,499.87**. Central contributes around **501,239.89**, while South has the lowest regional sales at **391,721.91**. West and East together account for about 61% of total sales, so they are the strongest regions by sales value. The business should protect service levels in these regions while investigating whether successful products or customer approaches can be adapted elsewhere. Lower sales in South do not automatically mean poor performance; customer mix, competition, order size, and profit margin should also be reviewed.

Category performance. Technology is the largest category by sales, at approximately **836,154.03**. Furniture follows with **741,718.42**, while Office Supplies contributes approximately **719,047.03**. Technology leads the three categories, but all three make meaningful contributions. These are sales amounts, not profit figures. Product costs, discounts, returns, and delivery expenses may affect profitability, so category decisions should consider profit and margin as well as revenue.

Monthly sales trend. February is the lowest month at approximately **59,751.25**, while January is also relatively low at **94,924.84**. Sales increase strongly in March to **205,005.49**, then remain more moderate through much of the middle of the year. September rises to **307,649.95**, followed by a strong November result of **352,461.07**. December is also high at **325,293.50**. November is the strongest month in the provided monthly summary. This may reflect seasonal demand or year-end purchasing, but a single year of monthly totals cannot prove the cause. Comparing the same months across multiple years would help confirm whether the pattern repeats.

Individual products and dashboard usability. The Power BI bar chart now lists individual product names with sales values, which is more useful for identifying strong-selling items than a category-only chart. Applying a Top 10 filter would make leading products easier to compare. The dashboard includes KPI cards, a monthly line chart, a regional pie chart, and Year, Region, and Category slicers. Clear all filters before quoting company-wide totals, because selected filters can change the values displayed.

3. Business Recommendations

- **Plan stock ahead of peak months.** Use the high sales in September, November, and December as a signal to review inventory, supplier lead times, and delivery capacity before the busy period. Use several years of data and product-level trends to forecast demand instead of assuming every year will follow the same pattern.
- **Investigate the low-sales period.** Review January and February sales by region, category, customer segment, and product. Test targeted promotions, bundles, or customer re-engagement campaigns during quieter months. Assess every discount against its effect on profit, not just the additional sales it generates.
- **Protect and learn from strong regions.** Maintain good service levels in West and East. Examine which products, customer groups, and order types drive their results, then test whether successful approaches can be adapted for Central and South. Compare regional profit and profit margin before allocating more budget.
- **Create a focused growth plan for South.** Review customer coverage, product availability, delivery experience, repeat-purchase rates, and competitor pricing to identify why sales are lower. Run a small, measurable pilot—such as a targeted campaign or selected product range—before making a large investment.

- **Manage categories using profit as well as revenue.** Technology leads sales, but category-level profit and margin should be checked to determine whether it is also the most profitable category. For Furniture and Office Supplies, identify products with good margins and reliable demand, and avoid broad discounts that may reduce profitability.
- **Use a Top 10 product view.** Filter the product chart to the ten highest-selling products and review their sales, profit, and order frequency. Keep popular items available, but check whether high sales are accompanied by low or negative profit. A separate view of least-profitable products can identify items that may need repricing or supplier review.
- **Improve the dashboard for routine monitoring.** Keep one Total Sales card and one Total Profit card to avoid duplicate information. Give each visual a clear title, format figures consistently, and verify that Year, Region, and Category slicers affect all relevant visuals. Make the current date range or filter state clear to readers.
- **Set measurable monthly targets.** Track sales, profit, and profit margin each month. Compare actual results with targets and the same month in previous years. This helps distinguish seasonality from changes linked to a region, category, or product, and shows whether an action has improved performance.

4. Conclusion

The Excel PivotTables and Power BI dashboard turn raw Superstore data into a clearer view of business performance. The full dataset records about 2.30 million in sales and 286.4 thousand in profit. West and East are the leading regions by sales, Technology is the leading category, and September through December—particularly November—are important months to investigate for planning. These findings can guide stock planning, regional campaigns, and product reviews. The next step is to compare sales with profit and margins at product, category, and regional levels, and validate seasonal patterns with additional years of data. The dashboard is a decision-support tool: it highlights where to investigate, while further analysis is needed before concluding why a trend occurred.

Data notes: Values are presented in the units used by the source dataset; no currency symbol has been added. Regional, category, and monthly values are taken from the Excel PivotTable screenshot. The Power BI screenshot shows full-dataset totals after the year filter appears cleared. Confirm these totals in the saved PBIX file before submission, and ensure Excel and Power BI use the same cleaned dataset.